

Decory Edwards
Johns Hopkins University
Department of Economics

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Hiring Committee
Old Mission Capital
Chicago, IL

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Junior Quantitative Trader position for 2026 graduates at Old Mission Capital. I am currently a PhD candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University. My training combines mathematical reasoning, computational modeling, and data driven empirical analysis. I am motivated by problems that require disciplined decision making, careful implementation, and constant evaluation under uncertainty. Old Mission's focus on research driven trading and team based execution aligns closely with how I approach quantitative work.

My research agenda is at the intersection of wealth inequality and macroeconomics. In my job market paper, I build and estimate a structural heterogeneous agent model with returns that differ across households. The core contribution is to show how heterogeneity in returns and income risk jointly shape the wealth distribution and consumption behavior. Relative to closely related work, my framework performs better at matching the lower and middle portions of the wealth distribution. This difference matters quantitatively. Models that focus primarily on returns heterogeneity can fit the top of the wealth distribution closely but tend to generate too much wealth among the bottom half of households. In my framework, income uncertainty generates a precautionary saving motive that produces genuinely low wealth households. This leads to a realistic distribution of marginal propensities to consume and aggregate consumption responses that align with empirical estimates.

A key feature of my research is the heavy use of computation to solve and simulate models that cannot be handled analytically. I write code to solve dynamic programming problems, simulate outcomes under stochastic environments, and evaluate performance across scenarios. This work requires disciplined reasoning, attention to risk, and the ability to adapt models quickly as new information arrives. These skills translate naturally to trading environments that demand fast learning, risk management, and robust decision making.

I am particularly interested in Old Mission Capital because of its emphasis on proprietary trading, internal research, and collaborative team structures. The opportunity to work closely with experienced traders while contributing to strategy development and execution is especially appealing. I value environments that reward curiosity, integrity, and performance under pressure, and I am motivated by roles where results are clear and accountability is high.

My economics training has provided a strong foundation in probability, optimization, and statistical reasoning. I am comfortable working with Python and other quantitative tools to analyze data, price risk, and test strategies. I also value clear communication and teamwork, both of which are essential when trading decisions are made collaboratively and under time constraints.

I am also enthusiastic about the prospect of living and working in Chicago. I value in person

collaboration and the intensity of a trading floor environment. I see this role as an opportunity to apply my analytical training in a setting that rewards precision, adaptability, and long term commitment.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my skills and perspective to Old Mission Capital. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards